

Thought for 11s >

Here is the state of the investigation as I understand it.

1. Physical setup

You have:

- **AT&T Fiber 1G** internet coming into the house.
- An **AT&T fiber gateway/router** still present in the house.
 - Exact model number: **not yet confirmed**.
 - It appears to be broadcasting its own Wi-Fi network called `Dionysus10`.
- A **Synology RT6600ax** router, which is intended to be your main Wi-Fi router.
 - Model confirmed from the router label screenshot: **Synology RT6600ax**.
 - Running Synology SRM; it was previously behind on updates, but you updated it and it later showed as up to date.

House conditions:

- 1906 San Francisco house.
- Lath/plaster construction, likely hostile to Wi-Fi.
- Three levels.
- Router is on the middle floor, near the kitchen/hallway.
- Problem areas:
 - living room/front room
 - back deck
 - upstairs bedrooms
 - sometimes lower bedroom
- You have Ethernet jacks in rooms, all terminating centrally, which means a wired access point solution is available if needed.

2. Main Wi-Fi networks we have seen

Synology network

Primary SSID:

`Dionysus`

Current/known Synology settings:

- Smart Connect: usually **ON**
- Security: **WPA2-Personal**
- 2.4 GHz channel: changed from **1** to **6**
- 2.4 GHz width: **20 MHz**
- 5 GHz has been seen around channels **40/44**

- 5 GHz width: **80 MHz**
- PMF: **Disabled**
- DTIM: **4**
- Key rotation: **3600 seconds**
- AMPDU: **On**
- U-APSD: **On**
- MU-MIMO: **On**
- OFDMA: **On**
- 802.11r: **Off**
- AP isolation: **Off**
- “Disable Smart Connect for devices not supporting 802.11v”: **On**

AT&T gateway network

The AT&T gateway appears to be broadcasting:

Dionysus10

Your scan showed three instances:

- Dionysus10 on **2.4 GHz**, channel **3**, 802.11n, strong signal around **-38**
- Dionysus10 on **5 GHz**, channel **48**, 802.11ax, signal around **-53**
- Dionysus10 on **5 GHz**, channel **132**, 802.11ax, signal around **-61**

That likely means the AT&T gateway is broadcasting on multiple radios. That is normal for a dual-band/tri-band router, but it is not ideal if Synology is supposed to be the only Wi-Fi system.

3. What the symptoms are

The original symptom was not just “slow Wi-Fi.”

The important symptom is:

Your iPhone sometimes loses the Wi-Fi icon completely for 5–10 seconds, then reconnects by itself.

You have seen this on:

- 2.4 GHz
- 5 GHz

That matters because it means the issue is not just one bad 2.4 GHz channel.

You also saw very bad usable performance in some spots, especially the living room/front room. Example:

- living room on isolated renamed network: **2.6 Mbps**, essentially unusable

4. Speed tests we ran / observed

Near the Synology router, performance is excellent:

- iPhone near router: around **860 Mbps**
- iPad near router: around **610 Mbps**
- Earlier close-router tests were also several hundred Mbps

That tells us:

- AT&T fiber itself is fine.
- The Synology router can produce fast Wi-Fi nearby.
- The iPhone and iPad hardware are not inherently broken.

After changing 2.4 GHz from channel 1 to channel 6, quick tests showed:

Location	iPhone	iPad	Meaning
Router	860 Mbps	610 Mbps	Excellent
Kitchen	69 Mbps	180 Mbps	Usable but lower than expected
Bedroom	14 Mbps	28 Mbps	Poor
Living room	22 Mbps	130 Mbps	Mixed/weak

Then within 30 minutes, the iPhone still dropped Wi-Fi twice:

- once on the back deck while on **2.4 GHz**
- once in the front/living room while on **5 GHz**

So channel 6 did **not** solve the stability problem.

5. What we tried

A. Updated Synology SRM

You updated the router software. Good necessary step, but it did not by itself resolve the issue.

B. Confirmed router performance near the router

Near-router speeds were excellent. This ruled out a basic ISP/router-throughput problem.

C. Ran Apple Wireless Diagnostics scan

We found:

- many neighboring networks

- Synology `Dionysus` on 2.4 GHz channel 1 initially
- Apple suggested 2.4 GHz channel 6
- a strong nearby/inside signal on channel 1
- later, AT&T `Dionysus10` showed up strongly on overlapping channels

D. Changed Synology 2.4 GHz channel from 1 to 6

Result:

- Some quick-test performance improved/was usable.
- But Wi-Fi still dropped afterward.
- So this was not the full fix.

E. Tried to create a temporary 5 GHz-only test network

We tried creating something like:

- `Dionysus-5gTest`
- `Dionysus-5gTest_5G_1`
- later maybe a simpler `D5TEST`

But it did not appear in iPhone scan or Mac Wireless Diagnostics. That means the test SSID was not actually broadcasting.

This path became unproductive.

F. Tried turning Smart Connect off / split bands

When you turned Smart Connect off, SRM revealed old stale per-band names/passwords, like an old temporary name — “New Highland” or similar.

Then, after trying to split bands, only the **2.4 GHz** network appeared. The 5 GHz network did not show, even sitting by the router. A reboot did not fix that while Smart Connect was off.

Then when you turned Smart Connect back on, **5 GHz came back**.

That is an important clue: the 5 GHz radio is not dead, but the split-band configuration in SRM seems stale, confused, or misapplied.

G. Renamed primary network to kick off all existing devices

This was the “bad IoT / too many devices” test.

You renamed the main network, which kicked off all bulbs, plugs, cameras, appliances, etc.

Result:

- With the old devices kicked off, the living room still became essentially unusable.

- Fast.com eventually returned around **2.6 Mbps**.

That makes the “one bad Kasa bulb is wrecking everything” theory much weaker.

It does not rule out every IoT issue forever, but it is no longer my leading theory.

6. What we have learned

Strong conclusions

1. AT&T fiber is not the bottleneck.

Near-router speeds are excellent.

2. The Synology RT6600ax is capable of high speed nearby.

It is not simply “a slow router.”

3. The iPhone/iPad are not fundamentally broken.

They both perform well near the router.

4. This is not just a 2.4 GHz channel-1 problem.

The phone dropped on both 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz after the channel change.

5. The smart-home device crowd theory is weaker now.

You kicked them off and the living room was still bad.

6. The living room/front room path is genuinely bad.

This is likely a coverage/path issue through old plaster and distance.

7. The AT&T gateway Wi-Fi is a major new suspect.

`Dionysus10` is broadcasting strongly inside the house and overlapping with Synology.

8. Synology’s split-band configuration looks messy/stale.

The old hidden per-band names and failure to broadcast 5 GHz when split are not normal behavior.

7. What we have mostly ruled out

Mostly ruled out:

- Bad AT&T fiber service
- Bad iPhone hardware
- Bad iPad hardware
- Synology being incapable of fast Wi-Fi
- Simple “change 2.4 channel and everything is fixed”
- A single obvious bad smart bulb/plug as the main cause

Not fully ruled out:

- Synology Smart Connect weirdness
- Synology configuration cruft
- AT&T gateway Wi-Fi interference
- Physical coverage problem

- Need for wired access points
- Synology router Wi-Fi instability under real-world conditions

8. Current theory ranking

My current ranking is:

1. AT&T gateway Wi-Fi interference + competing Wi-Fi system

This has jumped way up the list.

You appear to have two strong Wi-Fi systems broadcasting in the same house:

- Synology `Dionysus`
- AT&T gateway `Dionysus10`

The AT&T gateway is on overlapping/problematic channels:

- 2.4 GHz channel 3 overlaps with Synology channel 6
- 5 GHz channel 48 overlaps or competes with Synology's nearby 5 GHz channels at 80 MHz width

Even if your devices are not connected to `Dionysus10`, it can still consume airtime and interfere.

2. Physical coverage/path problem

The living room/front room is horizontally away from the router through an old house. That is a classic bad Wi-Fi path.

The fact that the router is excellent nearby but poor in the living room strongly supports this.

3. Synology Smart Connect / configuration issue

Smart Connect may still be contributing, especially because:

- drops happened on both bands
- split-band behavior was weird
- old stale network names appeared
- 5 GHz only returned cleanly when Smart Connect came back on

But because the split-band test became unreliable, I would not keep poking at this first.

4. Router/SRM configuration cruft

The stale "New Highland" settings make me suspect the router has accumulated old Wi-Fi profiles that are confusing the UI or behavior.

Not proven, but suspicious.

5. Old IoT devices

Still possible as a secondary irritant, especially on 2.4 GHz, but no longer the main suspect after the renamed-network test.

9. Best next steps

Step 1: Turn off Wi-Fi on the AT&T gateway

Do **not** turn off or unplug the gateway. You still need it for fiber/internet.

Turn off only:

- AT&T 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi
- AT&T 5 GHz Wi-Fi
- AT&T guest Wi-Fi
- any AT&T extender/mesh Wi-Fi if present

Then run Mac Wireless Diagnostics scan again.

Goal:

`Dionysus10` should disappear completely.

This is the cleanest next test.

Step 2: Leave Synology simple

For now:

- Synology SSID: `Dionysus`
- Smart Connect: **ON**
- 2.4 GHz channel: **6**
- Do not split bands again tonight
- Delete/disable test networks

Step 3: Retest

After AT&T Wi-Fi is off:

Test:

- by router
- kitchen
- living room/front room
- back deck
- bedroom

But the most important metric is still:

Does the Wi-Fi icon disappear?

Not just speed.

Step 4: If AT&T Wi-Fi removal improves stability but living room remains slow

Then the fix is likely a **wired access point** in or near the living room.

Because you have Ethernet everywhere, this is the right architecture:

- Synology RT6600ax remains main router
- Add one wired AP in living/front-room area
- Use Ethernet backhaul
- Do not rely on wireless mesh if Ethernet is available

Likely Synology-compatible option:

- **Synology WRX560** as wired mesh/AP node

But I would not buy it until after turning off AT&T Wi-Fi and testing.

Step 5: If AT&T Wi-Fi removal does not help

Then I would consider:

1. Back up Synology configuration.
2. Clean up/delete stale Wi-Fi networks.
3. Possibly factory-reset Synology and rebuild the Wi-Fi config cleanly.
4. Or bypass Synology Wi-Fi entirely and move to a wired multi-AP system.

10. The most important current conclusion

The most actionable thing we have found is this:

Your AT&T gateway is still broadcasting strong Wi-Fi inside the house, and it is competing with the Synology Wi-Fi.

That should be fixed before buying hardware, blaming bulbs, or continuing to fight Smart Connect.